

ಕುಲ್ಲಂಗಾಲ್ ವಾರ್ತೆ

KULLANGAL VAARTE

The coast, in Kannada and English, in a morning read of numbered pages

THURSDAY, 1 OCTOBER 2026

ಗುರುವಾರ, ೧ ಅಕ್ಟೋಬರ್ ೨೦೨೬

10 PAGES, ABOUT TWENTY MINUTES

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1 Front page

ಮುಖಪುಟ

WEATHER TODAY	WIND	SUNRISE	SUNSET	MOON
32° / 26° Overcast, rain chance 78%	15 km/h Highest gust of the day, 10 m up	6:19 Mangaluru, calculated	18:21 Day length 12 h 1 min	78% Waning gibbous, calculated

COAST · MANGALURU

MRPL blast: police register case against two officials as refinery inquiry begins

One worker died and nine were hurt when a cold separator ruptured at the Jokatte refinery on Wednesday.

A day after the blast and fire at the Coker Hydrotreater Unit of Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited (MRPL) near Jokatte, reports say the police have registered a case against two MRPL officials following a complaint. MRPL said a high-pressure cold separator ruptured around midday on Wednesday, 30 September, and a fire followed.

One person died and nine were injured, according to the reports. The man who died was a 30-year-old worker from Mulki. One report says the fire was fully put out by about 2.45 pm. Early counts differed (eight injured in the first reports, nine later), so the paper uses the later figure.

Reports on the condition of the injured differ, so this paper does not give a verdict on any one patient. Official statements from MRPL and the police will be followed in the coming days.

SOURCES [UNI](#) [THEPRINT](#) [DECCAN CHRONICLE](#) [DECCAN HERALD](#)

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BRIEFLY

Mangaluru: the railway area up to Ullal moves to Mysuru division of South Western Railway from today.

Konkan route: Mangaluru Central-Madgaon passenger (56616) leaving on 1 October is short-terminated at Karwar.

Udupi: yellow alert for heavy rain and thunderstorms in isolated places.

Bajpe: the Bantwal Catholic Credit Co-operative Society opens a branch tomorrow, 2 October.

2 Coast & Local

ಕರಾವಳಿ ಮತ್ತು ಸ್ಥಳೀಯ

MORE STORIES FROM THE COAST

MANGALURU

Mangaluru railway area moves to Mysuru division from 1 October

The railway network up to and including Ullal passes from the Palakkad Division of Southern Railway to the Mysuru Division of South Western Railway from 1 October. Reports say the region accounts for nearly 90 per cent of the Palakkad division's freight revenue, and the change is expected to help rake availability for industry.

1 OCT · [DAJIWORLD](#)

UDUPI & DAKSHINA KANNADA

Yellow alert for heavy rain on the coast

A yellow alert covering 12 districts of coastal, Malnad and south interior Karnataka was issued for Wednesday 30 September and Thursday 1 October, with heavy downpours and thunderstorms likely at isolated places in Dakshina Kannada and Udupi. The five-day forecast on this page shows how the week looks.

1 OCT · [DAJIWORLD](#)

MALPE

Fisherman missing after falling into the sea

A 28-year-old fisherman from Chhattisgarh, Dwarika Shikar, is reported missing after falling overboard from a Persian fishing boat that left Malpe harbour with other boats on 25 September.

1 OCT · [DAJIWORLD](#)

DHARMASTHALA / MANGALURU

SIT to begin fresh probe in the Soujanya case

The Special Investigation Team set up by the Karnataka government to reinvestigate the 2012 Soujanya case is to start its probe in Mangaluru on Thursday. It has been given three months to complete the work and report to the competent court.

1 OCT · [SOCIAL NEWS XYZ](#)

UDUPI

Tulu film 'Bellada Gatti': Udupi premiere sold out

Tickets for the Udupi premiere show of Raja Katapady's Tulu film 'Bellada Gatti' sold out. The show is on 1 October at 6.15 pm at Bharat Mall, Times Square Mall.

1 OCT · [DAJIWORLD](#)

KALLIANPUR

Foreign tourist found in distress, handed to Goa police

A Russian national found collapsed on the Kallianpur-Santhe Katte service road was produced before the district court and handed over to the Goa police. Police found his entry permit had expired and a case against him was pending in Goa.

1 OCT · [DAJIWORLD](#)

MANGALURU

Mangalore University drops 16 postgraduate programmes

Mangalore University has temporarily discontinued 16 postgraduate programmes for 2026-27 because they did not attract the minimum number of students.

30 SEP · [MANGALORE TODAY](#)

BANTWAL / BAJPE

Credit society opens Bajpe branch tomorrow

The Bantwal Catholic Credit Co-operative Society's Bajpe branch is scheduled to open on 2 October.

ANNOUNCED 30 SEP · [DAJIWORLD](#)

FIVE DAYS AHEAD IN MANGALURU

TODAY	32° / 26°	Overcast Rain chance 78%, 0 mm
FRI 2 OCT	32° / 26°	Light drizzle Rain chance 94%, 1.2 mm
SAT 3 OCT	29° / 24°	Thunderstorm Rain chance 100%, 16.7 mm
SUN 4 OCT	30° / 24°	Light showers Rain chance 100%, 4.5 mm
MON 5 OCT	29° / 24°	Light drizzle Rain chance 99%, 2.4 mm

High / low in °C. Model forecast from [Open-Meteo.com](#) for 12.91°N 74.86°E, fetched 1 October 2026, 11:38 India time. A forecast, not an observation.

Sunrise 6:19, sunset 18:21 (calculated). Moon: Waning gibbous, 78% lit (calculated).

COMING UP

FRI 2 OCT Gandhi Jayanti, and the opening of the Bajpe branch of the Bantwal Catholic Credit Co-operative Society.

MON 5 OCT Konkani film 'Bapache Putache Navim' is scheduled to screen in Palimar.

SUN 11 OCT Navaratri begins across Karnataka; Mysuru Dasara is inaugurated the same day.

TUE 20 OCT Mahanavami and Ayudha Puja.

WED 21 OCT Vijayadashami, the last day of Dasara.

SOURCES **DASARA DATES, KANNADA PANCHANGA**

NUMBERS WORTH KEEPING

112

Police, fire and ambulance (national emergency number)

100

Police

101

Fire

108

Ambulance

1091

Women's helpline

1098

Child helpline

KULLANGAL & NEARBY · NOTICES FOR THE DAY

No reader notices today. If something is happening in Kullangal or nearby, send it in.

Send us your news

Events, lost and found, road works, temple and school notices, shop openings, club and school sports results.

Reader notices are not open yet. Until the form is ready the editor cannot take notices, so please do not send them anywhere for now.

KULLANGAL VAARTE · 2/10

TAKE A BREAK ನಗು

IN ENGLISH

Customer: There is a fly in my soup. Waiter:
Sir, that is the chef's way of saying the soup
is fresh.

ಕನ್ನಡದಲ್ಲಿ

ಮಳೆಗಾಲದ ಸತ್ಯ: ಕೊಡೆ ತಂದ ದಿನ ಮಳೆ ಬರುವುದಿಲ್ಲ,
ಮರೆತ ದಿನ ಜೋರಾಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತದೆ.

3 Coast Feature

ವಿಶೇಷ ಲೇಖನ

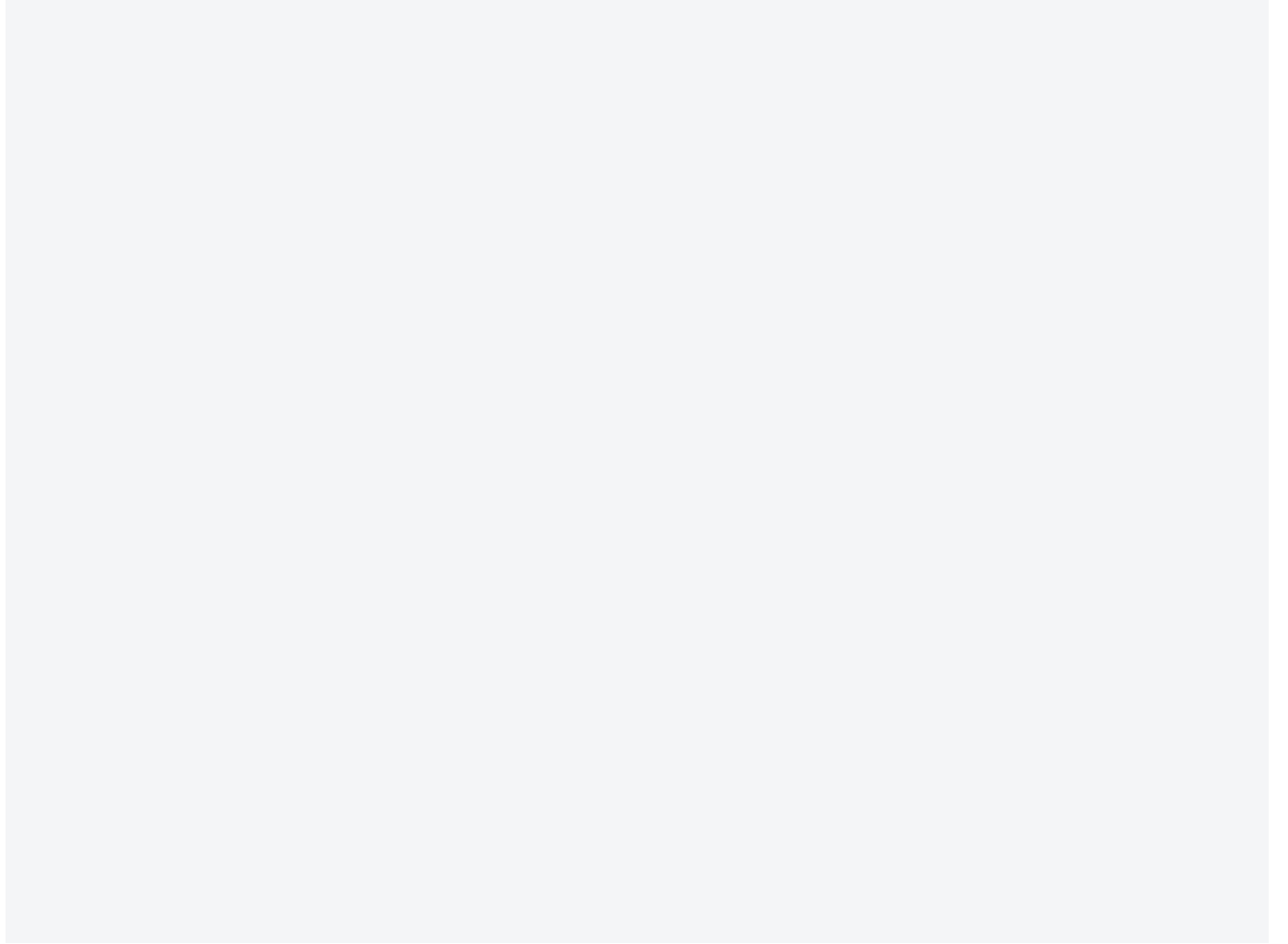


Photo: SamrudhKottary, [Wikimedia Commons](#), CC BY-SA 4.0

TRADITION · A COAST FEATURE

Kambala: racing through the paddy slush

Kambala is the buffalo race of coastal Karnataka. Pairs of buffaloes are driven through a flooded, muddy paddy track by a farmer who runs behind, holding a rope and a plough or a wooden board.

The season usually runs from about November to March, after the harvest. Winners are judged on speed and on how high the mud is thrown, and the events are held across Dakshina Kannada and Udupi, drawing large crowds.

Kambala began as a farmers' celebration of the harvest, and today it is a major sporting tradition with its own rules and a governing body, though it has also drawn debate about the treatment of the animals.

One feature every day, on a different subject each weekday: food, art, places, tradition, the sea, nature and temples.

4 Kannada Kadambari

ಕನ್ನಡ ಕಾದಂಬರಿ

ಸಂಚಿಕೆ ೨ • ಸಮುದ್ರ ನಿಲಯ

ಉಯಿಲು

ಹಿಂದಿನ ಸಂಚಿಕೆಯಲ್ಲಿ

ಮಳೆಯ ರಾತ್ರಿ ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿನಿಂದ ಅಜ್ಜನ ಮನೆ ಸಮುದ್ರ ನಿಲಯಕ್ಕೆ ಬಂದ ಅನನ್ಯಾ, ಅಜ್ಜ ರಾಮಣ್ಣ ಶೆಟ್ಟರ ಸಾವಿನ ಹನ್ನೆರಡನೇ ದಿನ ಮನೆಯ ಮಾಳಿಗೆಯ ದೀಪ ಆರಿರುವುದನ್ನು ಕಂಡಳು. ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ ಕಡಲಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಯಾರದೋ ಕಂದೀಲು ಮಿಣುಕುತ್ತಿತ್ತು.

ಮರುದಿನ ಬೆಳಿಗ್ಗೆ ಮಳೆ ನಿಂತಿದ್ದರೂ ಆಕಾಶ ಮುಸುಕಾಗಿಯೇ ಇತ್ತು. ಅಂಗಳದ ಹುಲ್ಲಿನ ಮೇಲೆ ಮಳೆನೀರಿನ ಹನಿಗಳು ಮುತ್ತಿನಂತೆ ನಿಂತಿದ್ದವು. ಹತ್ತು ಗಂಟೆಗೆ ವಕೀಲ ಗೋಪಾಲಕೃಷ್ಣ ಭಟ್ ಸ್ಕೂಟರ್‌ನಲ್ಲಿ ಬಂದರು. ಅರವತ್ತು ವರ್ಷದ ಸಣ್ಣ ಮೈಕಟ್ಟಿನ ಮನುಷ್ಯ, ಕನ್ನಡಕದ ಮೇಲೆ ಕನ್ನಡಕ, ಕಂಕುಳಲ್ಲಿ ಕಪ್ಪು ಚೀಲ, ಕೈಯಲ್ಲಿ ಹಳೆಯ ಕಾಲದ ಕೊಡೆ. ಹಜಾರದ ದೊಡ್ಡ ಮರದ ಪೀಠದ ಮೇಲೆ ಅವರು ಕಾಗದಗಳನ್ನು ಹರಡಿದರು. ಎದುರಿನ ಕುರ್ಚಿಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಅನನ್ಯಾ, ಸುಮಿತ್ರಮ್ಮ, ಚಿಕ್ಕಪ್ಪ ಮಹಾಬಲ ಶೆಟ್ಟಿ ಕುಳಿತಿದ್ದರು. ಬಾಗಿಲ ಬಳಿ ಕಾವೇರಿ ಅಕ್ಕ ಸೆರಗು ಹಿಡಿದು ನಿಂತಿದ್ದರು. ಮಹಾಬಲ ಚಿಕ್ಕಪ್ಪ ಅಪ್ಪನ ಅಣ್ಣ, ಭಾರವಾದ ಮೈ, ದಪ್ಪ ಮೀಸೆ, ಬೆರಳಲ್ಲಿ ಮೂರು ಚಿನ್ನದ ಉಂಗುರ. ಹಜಾರದ ಗಡಿಯಾರದ ಟಿಕ್ ಟಿಕ್ ಸದ್ದು ಆ ಮೌನದಲ್ಲಿ ಜೋರಾಗಿ ಕೇಳುತ್ತಿತ್ತು.

ವಕೀಲರು ಕನ್ನಡಕ ಸರಿಮಾಡಿಕೊಂಡು ಉಯಿಲನ್ನು ಓದಿದರು. ಮೊದಲ ಸಾಲುಗಳು ಕೃತಜ್ಞತೆ, ಆಶೀರ್ವಾದ, ಕಾವೇರಿ ಅಕ್ಕನಿಗೆ ಒಂದಷ್ಟು ಹಣ, ಸುಮಿತ್ರಮ್ಮನಿಗೆ ಆಜೀವ ವಾಸದ ಹಕ್ಕು. ಮಹಾಬಲ ಚಿಕ್ಕಪ್ಪನಿಗೆ ತೆಂಗಿನ ತೋಟದ ಒಂದು ಭಾಗ. ಅವರು ಅದನ್ನು ಕೇಳಿ ಮೀಸೆ ತಿರುವಿದರು, ಅದು ಸಾಲದು ಎಂಬಂತೆ. ಆಮೇಲೆ ವಕೀಲರು ಧ್ವನಿಯನ್ನು ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ ಗಂಭೀರಗೊಳಿಸಿದರು. “ಸಮುದ್ರ ನಿಲಯ ಮತ್ತು ಅದರ ಸುತ್ತಲಿನ ಮೂರು ಎಕರೆ ಜಮೀನು ನನ್ನ ಮೊಮ್ಮಗಳು ಅನನ್ಯಾಗೆ ಸೇರುತ್ತದೆ.” ಹಜಾರದಲ್ಲಿ ಯಾರೋ ಸಣ್ಣಗೆ ಉಸಿರೆಳೆದರು. ಮಹಾಬಲ ಚಿಕ್ಕಪ್ಪನ ಮುಖ ಕೆಂಪಾಯಿತು, ಅವರ ಕೈ ಕುರ್ಚಿಯ ಹಿಡಿಕೆಯನ್ನು ಬಿಗಿಯಾಗಿ ಹಿಡಿಯಿತು.

“ಆದರೆ,” ಎಂದರು ವಕೀಲರು, “ಒಂದು ಷರತ್ತು ಇದೆ. ಮತ್ತು ಅದು ಉಯಿಲಿನ ಅತ್ಯಂತ ಮುಖ್ಯ ಭಾಗ ಎಂದು ರಾಮಣ್ಣನವರು ಸ್ವತಃ ಹೇಳಿದ್ದರು. ಅನನ್ಯಾ ನಲವತ್ತು ದಿನ ಈ ಮನೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ವಾಸ ಮಾಡಬೇಕು. ಆ ನಲವತ್ತು ದಿನಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಪ್ರತಿ ಸಂಜೆ ಸೂರ್ಯಾಸ್ತದ ನಂತರ ಮಾಳಿಗೆಯ ದೀಪ ಉರಿಯಬೇಕು. ಒಂದು ದಿನ ತಪ್ಪಿದರೂ ಮನೆ ಮತ್ತು ಜಮೀನು ಊರಿನ ಟ್ರಸ್ಟ್‌ಗೆ ಹೋಗುತ್ತದೆ.”

“ನಲವತ್ತು ದಿನ?” ಅನನ್ಯಾ ಗೆ ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿನ ಕೆಲಸ, ಮ್ಯಾನೇಜರ್‌ನ ಮುಖ, ಅಪಾರ್ಟ್‌ಮೆಂಟಿನ ಬಾಡಿಗೆ ಎಲ್ಲವೂ ಒಂದೇ ಬಾರಿ ನೆನಪಾದವು. “ಅಜ್ಜ ಹೀಗೆ ಯಾಕೆ ಬರೆದರು? ಒಂದು ದೀಪಕ್ಕಾಗಿ ಇಷ್ಟೆಲ್ಲಾ?” “ಇದು ಹುಚ್ಚುತನ!” ಎಂದು ಮಹಾಬಲ ಚಿಕ್ಕಪ್ಪ ಗರ್ಜಿಸಿದರು. “ನಲವತ್ತು ದಿನ ಒಬ್ಬ ಹುಡುಗಿ ಕಾಡಿನಂಥ ಈ ಮನೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಒಬ್ಬಳೇ? ಉಯಿಲನ್ನು ನ್ಯಾಯಾಲಯದಲ್ಲಿ ಪ್ರಶ್ನಿಸುತ್ತೇನೆ!” ಸುಮಿತ್ರಮ್ಮ ಒಂದು ಮಾತೂ ಆಡದೆ ತಲೆ ತಗ್ಗಿಸಿಕೊಂಡೇ ಇದ್ದರು.

ವಕೀಲರು ಹೊರಟ ಮೇಲೆ ಅನನ್ಯಾ ಅಂಗಳದ ತುಳಸಿ ಕಟ್ಟೆಯ ಬಳಿ ಒಬ್ಬಳೇ ನಿಂತಿದ್ದಳು. ಹಿಂದಿನಿಂದ ಭಾರವಾದ ಹೆಜ್ಜೆಗಳು ಕೇಳಿಸಿದವು. ಮಹಾಬಲ ಚಿಕ್ಕಪ್ಪ ಈಗ ಮುಖದ ಮೇಲೆ ಬೇರೆಯೇ ನಗು ಹಚ್ಚಿಕೊಂಡಿದ್ದರು, ವ್ಯಾಪಾರಿಯ ನಗು. “ನೋಡು ಮಗಳೇ, ನನಗೆ ನಿನ್ನ ಮೇಲೆ ಕೋಪವಿಲ್ಲ. ಈ ಮನೆ ಹಳೆಯದು, ಭಾವಣಿ ಸೋರುತ್ತದೆ, ತೋಟಕ್ಕೆ ಆಳು ಸಿಗುವುದಿಲ್ಲ. ನೀನು ನಲವತ್ತು ದಿನ ಈ ಕಾಡಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಹೇಗೆ ಇರ್ತೀಯಾ? ಒಂದು ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು. ಸಹಿ ಹಾಕಿ ಮನೆಯನ್ನು ನನಗೆ ಬಿಟ್ಟುಕೊಡು. ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ ಬೆಲೆ ಕೊಡಿಸುತ್ತೇನೆ. ಹಣ ಬ್ಯಾಂಕಿನಲ್ಲಿರುತ್ತದೆ, ನೀನು ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿನಲ್ಲಿ ನೆಮ್ಮದಿಯಾಗಿರಬಹುದು.”

“ಅಜ್ಜ ಯಾಕೆ ಹೀಗೆ ಬರೆದರು ಎಂದು ತಿಳಿಯುವವರೆಗೆ ನಾನು ಏನೂ ಸಹಿ ಹಾಕುವುದಿಲ್ಲ ಚಿಕ್ಕಪ್ಪ,” ಎಂದಳು ಅನನ್ಯಾ, ಅವಳೇ ಆಶ್ಚರ್ಯ ಪಡುವಷ್ಟು ಸ್ಥಿರವಾಗಿ. ಚಿಕ್ಕಪ್ಪನ ಕಣ್ಣಲ್ಲಿ ಒಂದು ಕ್ಷಣ ಏನೋ ಮಿಂಚಿ ಮರೆಯಾಯಿತು. “ಹಾಗೇ ಆಗಲಿ,” ಎಂದು ಮೀಸೆ ತಿರುವಿ ಹೊರಟರು. ಹಿಂದೆ ಅಡುಗೆಮನೆಯ ಕಿಟಕಿಯಿಂದ ಕಾವೇರಿ ಅಕ್ಕ ಇದನ್ನೆಲ್ಲ ನೋಡುತ್ತಿದ್ದರು. ಅವರು ತಲೆ ಆಡಿಸಿ ಮೆಲ್ಲಗೆ ಹೇಳಿಕೊಂಡದ್ದು ಅನನ್ಯಾ ಗೆ ಕೇಳಿಸಲಿಲ್ಲ, ಆದರೆ ತುಟಿಗಳ ಚಲನೆಯಿಂದ ಅವಳಿಗೆ ಅರ್ಥವಾಯಿತು: “ಈ ಹುಡುಗಿ ತನ್ನ ಅಪ್ಪನ ಹಾಗೇ.”

* * *

ಜನ ಹೊರಟ ಮೇಲೆ ವಕೀಲರು ಕೊನೆಯವರಾಗಿ ಹೊರಡುವಾಗ ಅನನ್ಯಾಳನ್ನು ಜಗಲಿಯಲ್ಲಿ ಕರೆದರು. ಅವರು ಕೊಡೆಯನ್ನು ಕೈಯಲ್ಲಿ ತಿರುಗಿಸುತ್ತಾ ಒಂದು ಕ್ಷಣ ಮಾತನಾಡಲಿಲ್ಲ. “ಗೊತ್ತಿಲ್ಲ ಮಗಳೇ ಅವರು ಯಾಕೆ ಹೀಗೆ ಬರೆದರು ಎಂದು,” ಎಂದರು ಕೊನೆಗೆ. “ಆದರೆ ಸಾಯುವ ಮೊದಲಿನ ವಾರ ಅವರು ನನ್ನನ್ನು ಕರೆಸಿದ್ದರು. ಆರೋಗ್ಯ ತುಂಬ ಕೆಟ್ಟಿತ್ತು, ಆದರೂ ಎದ್ದು ಕುಳಿತು ಈ ಉಯಿಲನ್ನು ಮೂರು ಬಾರಿ ತಿದ್ದಿಸಿದರು. ಮತ್ತು ಪದೇ ಪದೇ ಒಂದೇ ಮಾತು ಹೇಳುತ್ತಿದ್ದರು, ‘ಸಾಗರಿ ಮತ್ತೆ ಬರ್ತಾಳೆ. ದೀಪ ಆರಬಾರದು.’”

ಅನನ್ಯಾ ಮೊದಲ ಬಾರಿ ಆ ಹೆಸರನ್ನು ಕೇಳಿದಂತೆ ಇರಲಿಲ್ಲ. ಸಾಗರಿ ಅಜ್ಜನ ಹಳೆಯ ದೋಣಿಯ ಹೆಸರು. ಅವಳು ಹುಟ್ಟುವ ಮೊದಲಿನಿಂದಲೂ ಆ ಹೆಸರು ಮನೆಯ ಮಾತುಗಳಲ್ಲಿತ್ತು. ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತೈದು ವರ್ಷದ ಹಿಂದೆ, ಅವಳಿಗೆ ಎರಡು ವರ್ಷ ಆಗಿದ್ದಾಗ, ಒಂದು ಚಂಡಮಾರುತದ ರಾತ್ರಿ ಅವಳ ತಂದೆ ರಘುನಾಥ ಆ ದೋಣಿಯಲ್ಲಿ ಹೋದರು, ಮತ್ತೆ

ಹಿಂದಿರುಗಲಿಲ್ಲ. ಅವರ ದೇಹವೂ ಸಿಗಲಿಲ್ಲ, ದೋಣಿಯ ಒಂದು ಹಲಗೆಯೂ ಸಿಗಲಿಲ್ಲ. ಅಮ್ಮ ಕೆಲವು ವರ್ಷಕ್ಕೆ ಅವಳನ್ನು ಕರೆದುಕೊಂಡು ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿಗೆ ಹೋದರು. ಆ ಹೆಸರನ್ನು ಅವರು ಮತ್ತೆ ಎಂದೂ ಉಚ್ಚರಿಸಲಿಲ್ಲ.

ಅವಳು ಹಿಂದಿರುಗಿ ಹಜಾರದೊಳಗೆ ನೋಡಿದಾಗ ಸುಮಿತ್ರಮ್ಮ ಒಬ್ಬರೇ ಕುಳಿತಿದ್ದರು. ಅವರ ಕೈಯಲ್ಲಿದ್ದ ಚಹಾ ಲೋಟ ತುಸು ನಡುಗುತ್ತಿತ್ತು. ಆ ಮುಖದ ಮೇಲೆ ಅನನ್ಯ ಏನನ್ನೋ ಓದಿದಳು, ಅದು ದುಃಖವಲ್ಲ, ಕೋಪವಲ್ಲ, ಭಯ. ಇಷ್ಟು ವರ್ಷದ ನಂತರ ಒಂದು ಹೆಸರು ಕೇಳಿ ಹುಟ್ಟಿದ ಭಯ. ಅಂದೇ ಅವಳು ತೀರ್ಮಾನಿಸಿದಳು: ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿಗೆ ಫೋನ್ ಮಾಡಿ ರಜೆ ಹೆಚ್ಚಿಸಿಕೊಳ್ಳುತ್ತೇನೆ. ನಲವತ್ತು ದಿನ ಈ ಮನೆಯಲ್ಲೇ ಇರುತ್ತೇನೆ. ಈ ಮನೆ ಏನನ್ನು ಮುಚ್ಚಿಟ್ಟಿದೆಯೋ, ಅದನ್ನು ಕಂಡುಹಿಡಿಯುತ್ತೇನೆ.

ಮುಂದಿನ ಸಂಚಿಕೆ ನಾಳೆ ಇದೇ ಪುಟದಲ್ಲಿ.

ಕರಾವಳಿಯ ಕಡಲಕೆರೆ ಎಂಬ ಕಾಲ್ಪನಿಕ ಊರಿನ ಕಥೆ. ಇದರಲ್ಲಿರುವ ಎಲ್ಲ ಪಾತ್ರಗಳು ಮತ್ತು ಘಟನೆಗಳು ಕಾಲ್ಪನಿಕ.

► ಹಿಂದಿನ ಸಂಚಿಕೆಗಳು (1)

5 English Serial

ಇಂಗ್ಲಿಷ್ ಕಾದಂಬರಿ

EPISODE 2 · THE TIDE LEDGER

Column Seven

PREVIOUSLY

Ira Rao is at her desk in a Mangaluru newsroom when a retired clerk, soaked by the monsoon, hands her a ledger and a warning. She takes it home.

Ira's flat was on the first floor of an old house in Kodialbail, above a tailor's shop whose sewing machines went quiet at eight every night and began again, with a sound like a very small and very determined train, at half past eight the next morning. It had two rooms and a balcony that held a bucket and a bicycle. The landlady, Mrs D'Souza, lived downstairs and had views on everything from Ira's hours to the state of the nation, but she also left a steel tiffin of rice and fish curry on the stairs on Wednesdays without ever mentioning it, which Ira understood to be love.

She ate the curry standing at the counter, because she was too restless to sit. Then she made a glass of ginger tea, spread an old bedsheet over the table for no reason she could name except that it seemed wrong to open the thing on a bare surface, and finally, with the rain drumming on the tin roof of the verandah below, she opened the ledger.

It was a plain accounts book, ruled in faded red, filled with entries in a small, upright, extraordinarily careful hand: dates, boat numbers, quantities of diesel, quantities of ice, the cost of nets mended and engines repaired. Page after page of it, thirty-one years' worth of ordinary arithmetic, in the blue ink of someone who believed that a number written clearly could not be argued with. Ira turned the pages for a quarter of an hour and felt her eyes begin to slide. Anyone who has ever

tried to read an accounts book for pleasure will understand. She almost closed it. She actually had her hand on the cover when she noticed that the entries on the right-hand pages had begun to change.

It was subtle. The handwriting was the same, but in the last three years of entries the columns had grown a seventh, headed in neat capitals ICE AND DIESEL, SEA CREST MARINE. The payments in column seven were not like the others. They were regular, they were large, and they were made to the same company, month after month, for boat after boat after boat. She counted. In March alone, the cooperative had paid Sea Crest Marine for ice and diesel for ninety-four boats. In April it was ninety-eight. By the time the pages reached the third winter it was a hundred and fourteen.

Ira, who was not good at sums but was very good at being suspicious of them, went and found a pencil and a page of rough paper and began to work. The Sasi Fishermen's Cooperative, she knew from her own diesel-queue story, represented about sixty working boats. She had interviewed the secretary. She had counted the boats in the harbour with her own eyes, standing on the jetty in a drizzle, with a photographer who had kept complaining about his lens. Sixty boats. Not a hundred and fourteen. She added the page twice, and the second time more slowly, with her finger running down the column, and the total did not change. It was not a clerical slip. It was a number that someone had meant.

* * *

She might have talked herself out of it even then, because she was a reasonable person and reasonable people look for reasonable explanations. Perhaps the cooperative supplied boats from other harbours. Perhaps ice and diesel were bought in bulk for the whole coast. But at the bottom of that last page, in the thin margin beside the final total, there was a line in pencil, so faint that she had to tilt the lamp to catch it. It was the same small, upright hand, but pressed so lightly it looked like

a thing written by someone who wanted it to be found and did not want it to be seen.

Boat 114 does not exist.

Ira sat very still. Outside, a scooter went through the puddle at the corner with a long sigh. Downstairs the tailor's cat knocked something off a shelf and was shouted at in Konkani. The lamp hummed. She thought of the old man on the newsroom floor with his broken umbrella, saying read it where the sea cannot hear, and she thought, for the first time, that perhaps he had not been strange at all. Perhaps he had simply been afraid in the ordinary, well-informed way of someone who knows exactly how much a number is worth.

She took out her phone and photographed the page, then the one before it, then every page with a seventh column, working carefully, because the light was bad and her hands were not entirely steady. When she had finished it was after midnight and the rain had thinned to a whisper. She wrote three words at the top of a clean sheet, BOAT 114, and underlined them twice. Then she sat and watched the sheet as though it might reply.

At a quarter to one, she called her mother back. It was a ridiculous time, and her mother answered on the first ring, alarmed, and Ira said, "Amma, I'm fine. I only wanted to say, tell me about the chartered accountant," and heard her mother go silent with astonishment, and then begin, slowly and with enormous care, to describe him, as though Ira were a deer that might bolt. It was, Ira found, a surprisingly comforting thing to listen to. A suitable boy, a flat in Udupi, a nice nature. She let her mother's voice run on, warm and ordinary, and looked at the ledger on the table, which was neither.

THE NEXT EPISODE ARRIVES TOMORROW ON THIS PAGE.

A junior reporter in Mangaluru is handed a ledger and a warning. Original fiction, written for this paper: all people and companies in it are invented.

► EARLIER EPISODES (1)

KULLANGAL VAARTE · 5/10

TAKE A BREAK ನಗು

IN ENGLISH

Why did the coconut go to the doctor? It kept getting cracked up.

ಕನ್ನಡದಲ್ಲಿ

ರೋಗಿ: ಡಾಕ್ಟರೇ, ನನಗೆ ಮರೆವು ಜಾಸ್ತಿ. ಡಾಕ್ಟರ್: ಎಷ್ಟು ದಿನದಿಂದ? ರೋಗಿ: ಯಾವುದರ ಬಗ್ಗೆ?

6 Puzzles I

ಒಗಟುಗಳು ೧

Sudoku MEDIUM

Fill every row, column and 3 by 3 box with the digits 1 to 9, once each. Tap a square, then write a number. Like a printed puzzle, it will not check your work or give hints. Your pencil marks stay on this device. The answer is in tomorrow's paper.

5	9				6			
1	7				4		6	9
8	6		1			3		4
	1		9			6		5
	4	9	6	5	2	7	8	
				1				
		8	5			4		
			2	4				
4				7		1	9	

Cryptogram DECODE

Every letter of a well-known saying has been swapped for another letter, always the same swap, and no letter stands for itself. Write your guess above each coded letter. The answer is in tomorrow's paper.

_ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ , _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _
 R S A W G G B S I L , G B X I W N X P L .

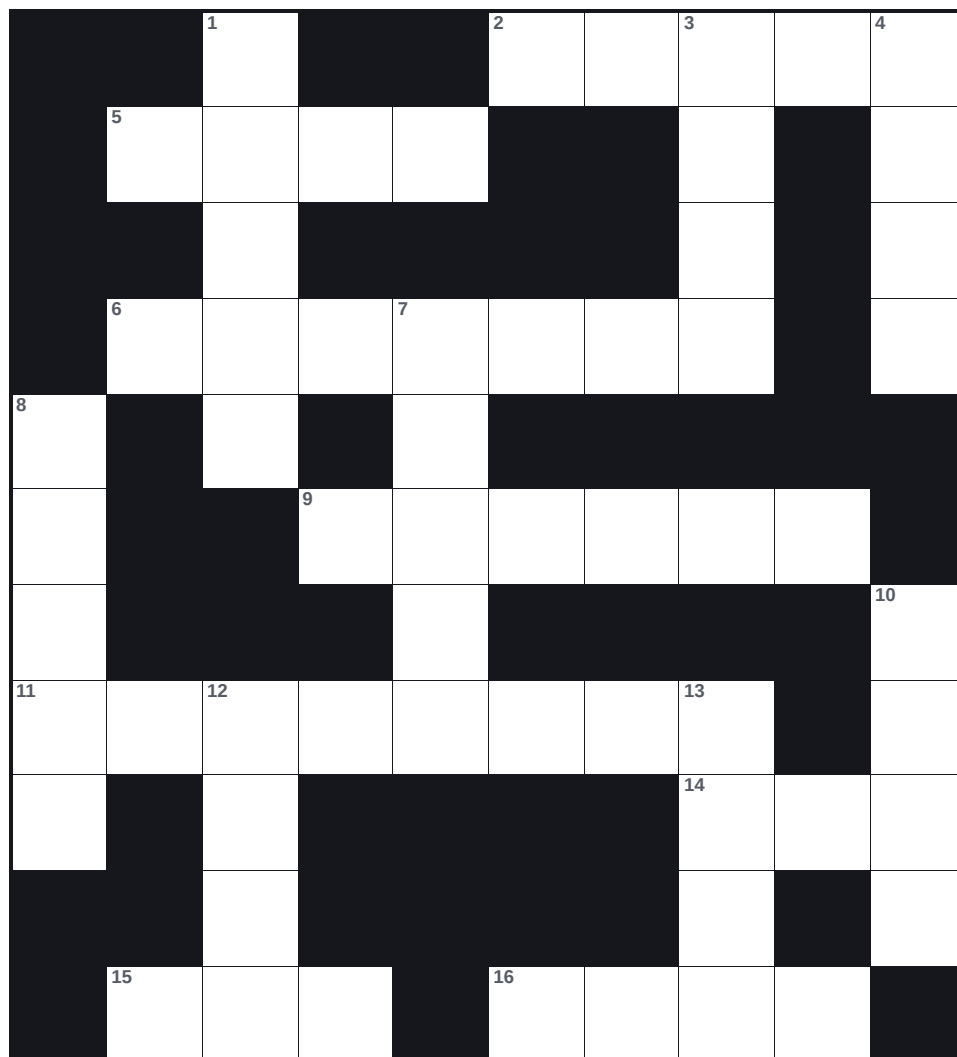
7 Puzzles II

ಒಗಟುಗಳು ೨

Mini crossword

COAST & INDIA

Tap a square and type. Tap the same square again to turn the direction from across to down. The answers are in tomorrow's paper.



ACROSS

- 2 Hill in Mangaluru with a temple to Manjunatha (5)
- 5 Temple instrument that rings (4)
- 6 ___ Sea: the water off Mangaluru (7)
- 9 Coffee-growing hill district of Karnataka (6)
- 11 Beach and port area on the northern side of Mangaluru (8)
- 14 Night bird with big eyes (3)
- 15 Hot drink made from leaves (3)
- 16 Paper toy flown in the wind (4)

DOWN

- 1 Gem made by an oyster (5)

- 3 First light of day (4)
- 4 India's space agency (4)
- 7 A flower in full flower (5)
- 8 Fishing harbour near Udupi, the launch point for St Mary's Islands (5)
- 10 Tree with fan or feather leaves (4)
- 12 Long river of Egypt (4)
- 13 Plant part that drinks from the soil (4)

Word search **FESTIVALS AND MUSIC**

Find these 10 words in the grid. Words run across, down or diagonally. Tap letters to mark them with a highlighter, and tap a word in the list to cross it off. Nothing is checked for you.

O	D	K	V	P	T	V	S	C	C	X	K
P	R	N	M	O	Y	E	K	O	Q	F	F
P	U	B	M	N	D	E	A	P	V	L	T
X	M	E	B	G	O	N	M	Z	N	U	B
D	B	L	Q	A	O	A	B	I	Z	T	A
K	U	L	R	L	T	R	A	Z	Y	E	I
Y	A	A	I	F	U	A	L	J	F	U	P
R	K	X	L	T	G	G	A	S	H	Q	O
V	Q	P	U	X	A	A	J	C	O	U	Q
I	K	X	E	J	D	R	H	M	L	A	I
P	V	C	R	J	I	G	R	H	I	Z	C
U	J	D	A	S	A	R	A	I	F	W	D

KAMBALA PONGAL DASARA FLUTE UGADI VEENA HOLI DRUM
RAGA BELL

Yesterday's answers

Wednesday, 30 September. Check your work against these.

SUDOKU

2	5	3	8	7	1	9	6	4
6	8	4	9	3	5	7	1	2
9	1	7	2	6	4	3	8	5
1	2	9	4	8	6	5	7	3
3	4	6	7	5	2	1	9	8
5	7	8	3	1	9	4	2	6
8	6	1	5	4	7	2	3	9
7	9	5	6	2	3	8	4	1
4	3	2	1	9	8	6	5	7

CROSSWORD, ACROSS

1. KAMBALA
4. NET
5. EAST
7. HARE
8. MAP

10. ISRO
11. MOON
13. KABADDI
14. DUSK

CROSSWORD, DOWN

2. ARECA
3. ANCHOR
6. PEARL
9. PONGAL

10. ISLAND
11. MUNDU
12. SILK

	K	A	M	B	A	L	A		
		R					N	E	T
		E	A	S	T		C		P
		C					H	A	R
	M	A	P				O		A
			O		I	S	R	O	
M	O	O	N		S				L
U			G		L			S	
N			K	A	B	A	D	D	I
D			L		N				L
U					D	U	S	K	

WORD SEARCH: GARDEN

U	L	X	R	C	L	U	R	H	G	L	U
V	Y	I	V	A	D	A	O	I	D	J	M
N	Y	N	Q	N	H	V	O	B	M	E	O
A	H	L	H	N	K	T	T	I	N	Y	N
D	F	V	S	A	Z	B	I	S	F	U	S
L	O	T	U	S	I	V	X	C	F	U	T
P	A	L	M	G	Z	O	F	U	Z	L	E
Y	X	U	A	A	F	X	T	S	P	E	R
W	B	L	O	O	M	P	F	Y	Q	A	A

U	P	S	J	A	S	M	I	N	E	F	L
U	A	X	M	S	E	E	D	S	L	P	O
N	X	D	F	I	G	B	O	J	D	L	H

CRYPTOGRAM

Every dog has its day.

KULLANGAL VAARTE · 7/10

TAKE A BREAK ನಗು

IN ENGLISH

Son: Dad, what is a budget? Dad: A budget is telling your money where to go instead of wondering where it went.

ಕನ್ನಡದಲ್ಲಿ

ಅಜ್ಜೋ ಡ್ರೆವರ್: ಎರಡು ನಿಮಿಷ ಸರ್, ಈಗ ಬಂದೆ.
(ಮೂವತ್ತು ನಿಮಿಷ ಕಳೆದ ಮೇಲೆ) ಇನ್ನೂ ಎರಡು ನಿಮಿಷ ಸರ್!

8 Garden

தேரடி

Three plants a day for a home on the coast: laterite soil, salty air and months of rain.

Photo: Clintacc, [Wikimedia Commons](#), CC0

Tulsi

ತುಳಸಿ *Ocimum tenuiflorum*

SACRED

HERB

EASY

Holy basil, native to India and kept in a raised tulasi katte outside many coastal homes. It is a leafy herb as much as a sacred plant.

LIGHT Full sun or partial sun.

WATER Light watering, like a shower. Daily in summer, every other day in cooler weather. Do not flood the pot.

SOIL Porous, well-drained, with added organic manure.

PRUNE Pinch the growing tip for a bushier plant and remove flower heads early to keep it leafy.

WATCH OUT Mealybugs, aphids, mites and whitefly. Spray a neem-based solution.

Photo: Forest and Kim Starr, [Wikimedia Commons](#), CC BY 3.0 us

Curry leaf

ಕರಿಬೇವು *Murraya koenigii*

KITCHEN GARDEN

EVERGREEN

The kitchen tree behind every tempering. It loves warmth, so it settles in easily on the coast and needs no protection from cold.

LIGHT Full sun.

WATER Deeply but not often. Let the top 3 to 5 cm dry between waterings to avoid root rot.

SOIL Well-drained soil that is rich in compost.

FEED Compost or organic manure every two to three months. Nitrogen-rich feed gives lush leaves.

HARVEST Pick leaves regularly from the tips so it keeps branching.

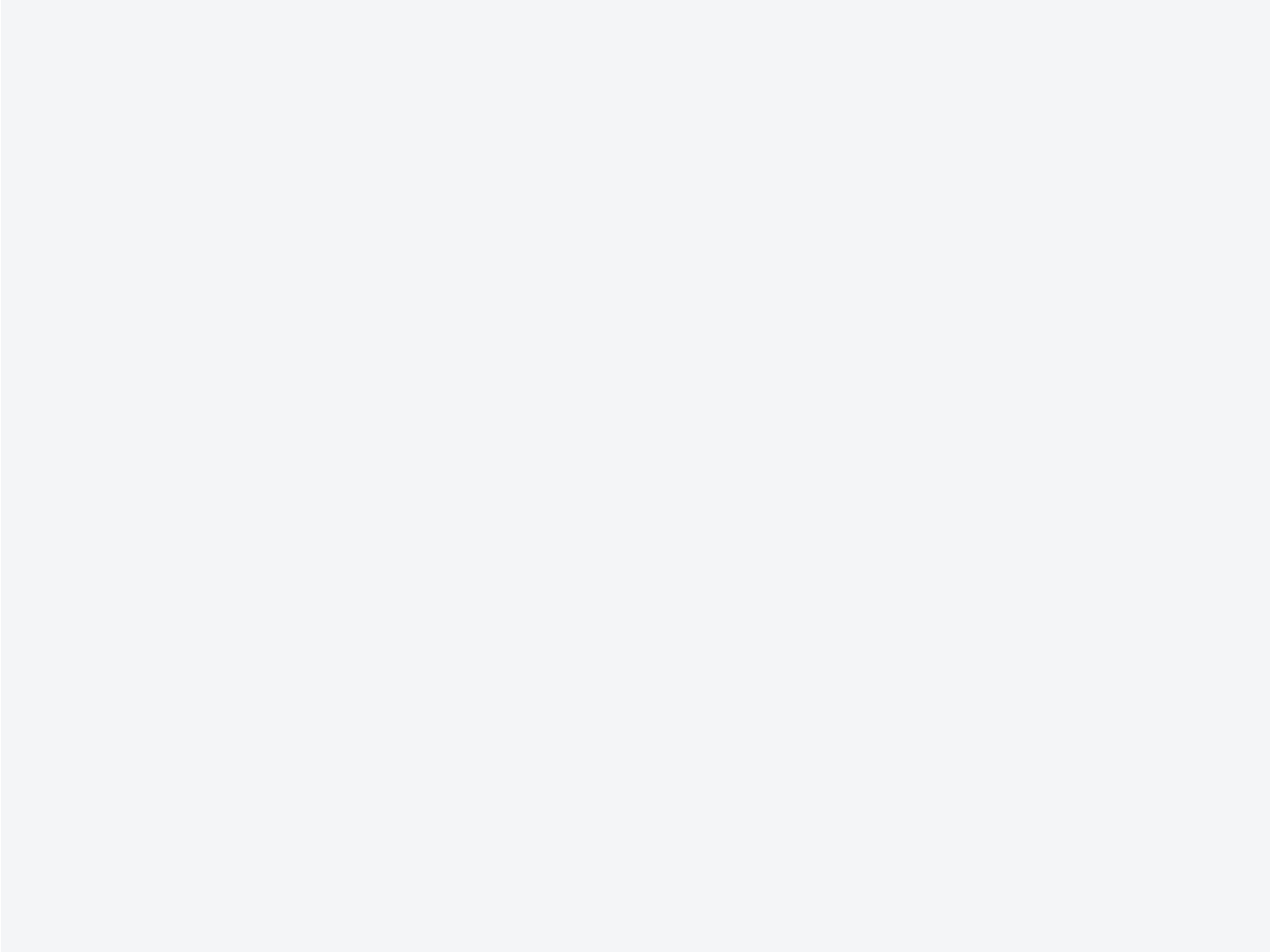


Photo: Mokie, [Wikimedia Commons](#), CC BY-SA 3.0

Monstera

Monstera deliciosa

INDOOR

LOVES HUMIDITY

The split-leaf climber that enjoys Mangaluru's humid air. It grows impressively through the monsoon months.

LIGHT Bright spot, away from direct afternoon sun.

WATER Moderate. Water only when the top of the soil starts to dry.

SOIL Mix in coarse sand or perlite for drainage.

AIR Give it airflow and watch for fungal spots in wet weather.

THIS MONTH IN THE GARDEN

0 OF 6 DONE THIS MONTH

☐

Check every pot has drainage holes, and clear the saucers after rain.

- ☐ Mulch bare soil to stop splash and keep roots steady.
- ☐ Give ferns and balcony plants airflow to avoid fungus.
- ☐ Sow spinach, amaranth and fenugreek, which enjoy the humidity.
- ☐ Shield young plants from strong wind and heavy downpours.
- ☐ Mix coarse sand into laterite soil so roots do not sit wet.

KULLANGAL VAARTE · 8/10

TAKE A BREAK ನಗು

IN ENGLISH

Fisherman's rule of three: the fish that got away was big, the one you caught was medium, and the one you tell people about was enormous.

ಕನ್ನಡದಲ್ಲಿ

ಶಿಕ್ಷಕರು: ಸಮುದ್ರದ ನೀರು ಯಾಕೆ ಉಪ್ಪು? ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿ: ಮೀನುಗಳು ಅದರಲ್ಲಿ ಅತ್ತಾ ಇರ್ತವೆ ಸರ್, ಅದಕ್ಕೆ.

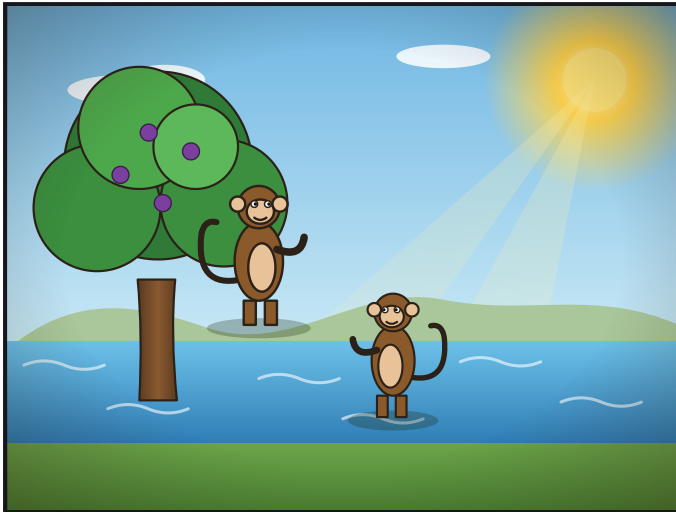
9 Tales

ಕತೆಗಳು

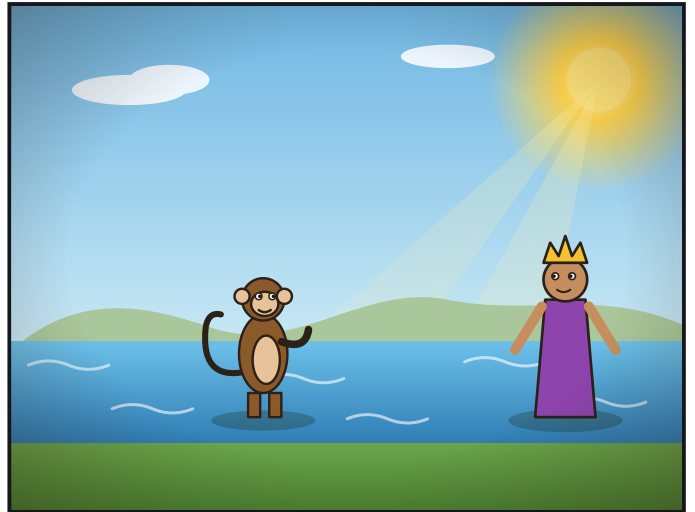
One old Indian tale a day, drawn as four panels with the moral at the end. Tomorrow: a Panchatantra tale. The stories are traditional and retold here in original words; the drawings are original.

JATAKA TALES · TODAY'S TALE

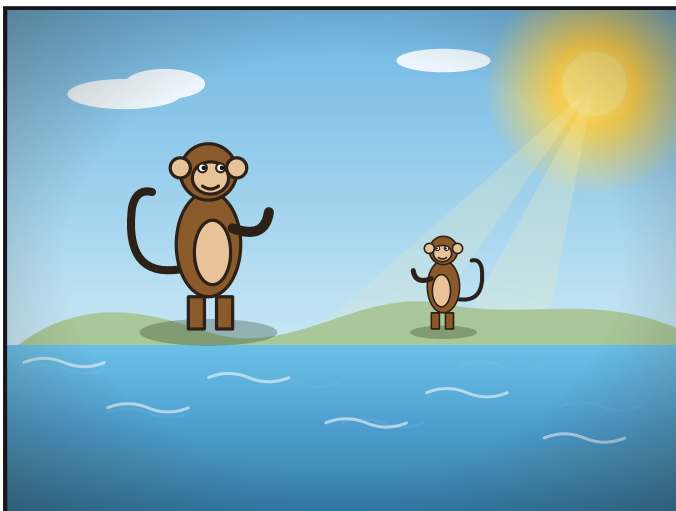
The Monkey King's Bridge



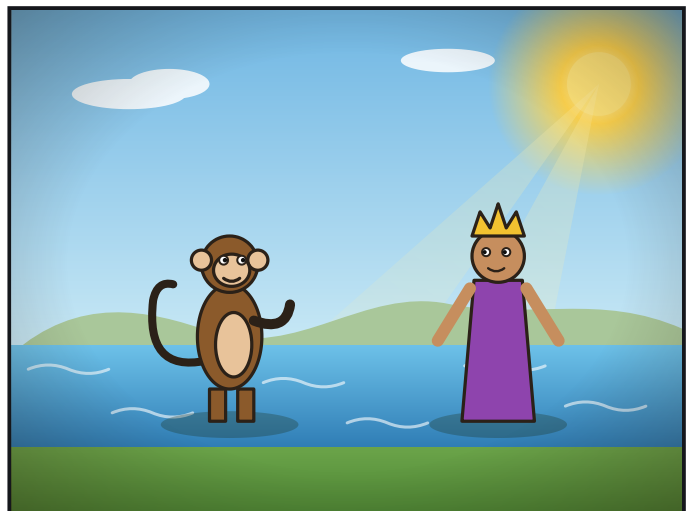
1 A monkey king led eighty thousand monkeys in a great mango tree beside the river. Everyone ate happily.



2 A king of men heard about the tree and sent his archers. Monkeys leapt in terror. The only way out was across the river.



3 The monkey king stretched his body from the tree to the far bank and made a living bridge. The monkeys crossed over his back.



4 The king of men watched, moved. He put down his bow and cared for the monkey king. He said, 'You are the true king of this forest.'

MORAL *A true leader thinks of others before himself.*

India chase 406 to win the second ODI; hockey semifinal against Pakistan today

CRICKET

2nd ODI: India chase 406 to win by 8 wickets

India reached 406 for 2 in 43.3 overs, with 39 balls to spare, after West Indies made 405 for 7 at Guwahati on 30 September. Shubman Gill scored 223 off 133 balls and Rohit Sharma 101 off 75; Ruturaj Gaikwad was not out on 31. West Indies' innings had centuries from Jangoo (114), Hope (104) and Campbell (101). India lead the three-match series 2-0.

SOURCES [ESPNCRICINFO AND OUTLOOK INDIA MATCH REPORTS](#)

ASIAN GAMES

Day 13: hockey and cricket semifinals

India's men play Pakistan in the hockey semifinal and Sri Lanka in the cricket semifinal on 1 October. After Day 12, India had 10 gold, 21 silver and 28 bronze medals and stood seventh in the table. Archery, shooting, cycling and squash offer medal chances today.

SOURCES [OUTLOOK INDIA, DAY 13 PREVIEW](#)

HOCKEY

Women's hockey team into the final

India's women's hockey team beat South Korea 2-0 to reach the Asian Games final, where they will face China for gold.

SOURCES [OUTLOOK INDIA](#)

KABADDI

Both kabaddi teams won gold

India's men's and women's kabaddi teams both won gold at the Asian Games; the kabaddi tournament ended on 26 September.

SOURCES [WIKIPEDIA, KABADDI AT THE 2026 ASIAN GAMES](#)

LOCAL SPORTS

Local club and school results from Mangaluru and Udupi are welcome. Send yours through the notice form on the Coast & Local page and it can appear on this page.

KULLANGAL VAARTE · 10/10

KULLANGAL VAARTE

Edition No. 2, built Thursday, 1 October 2026. News and sports facts come from the sources named under each item, gathered by web search and rewritten in our own words. Weather is from Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0). Sunrise, sunset and moon phase are calculated. Plant and feature photographs are from Wikimedia Commons with credits under each. The two serial novels, the puzzles, the comic drawings and the jokes are written or made for this paper; all people and companies in the serials are invented. Old illustrations on the Tales page are credited under them.

A new edition replaces this one each morning.